

Mauritius Examinations Syndicate
PSAC Specimen Paper 2026
HISTORY & GEOGRAPHY
MARK SCHEME

Question 1-Part A (10 marks)

Qu. No.	Answer	Mark allocation
1	B	1
2	C	1
3	D	1
4	B	1
5	A	1
6	B	1
7	C	1
8	C	1
9	A	1
10	D	1

Question 1-Part B (8 marks)

Qu. No.	Answer	Mark allocation
1	False	1
2	True	1

3	False	1
4	False	1
5	True	1
6	False	1
7	False	1
8	True	1

Question 2 (12 marks)

Qu. No.	Answer	Mark allocation										
Q 2 1. (a)	<table><tr><th>Column 1: Use</th><th>Column 2: Building</th></tr><tr><td>To look after sick sailors</td><td>Hospital</td></tr><tr><td>To store goods</td><td>Warehouses</td></tr><tr><td>To make flour</td><td>Windmill</td></tr><tr><td>To meet and take decisions</td><td>Government House</td></tr></table>	Column 1: Use	Column 2: Building	To look after sick sailors	Hospital	To store goods	Warehouses	To make flour	Windmill	To meet and take decisions	Government House	4
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To look after sick sailors	Hospital											
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To meet and take decisions	Government House											
Q 2 1. (b)	An aqueduct was built to bring/ supply water (1) to solve the water problem .(1)	2										
Q 2 2. (a) (i)	Champ de Mars	1										

Q 2 2.(a) (ii)	Award one mark for each correct answer • French : Soldiers marched and were trained there. • British : It became a place /track for horse racing / leisure / recreation.	2
Q 2 2.(b) (i)	• Harbour / port / docks / dry docks / deep water quays / quays	1
Q 2 (b) (ii)	Award one mark each for any two of the followings: • British ships coming from Europe and going to India stopped at Port Louis. • It was used as a stopover / a port of call / a refreshment station. • Goods were sold and exchanged there/ Because of entrepot trade. • Port Louis became an important business and commercial centre. • For trade- to load and / or unload goods. • It was the main warehouse on the route to the East. • Because of its strategic location (in this part of the world / Indian Ocean).	2
Question 3 (7 marks)		
Q 3 1. (a)	Country 1 : Mozambique (1) Country 2 : Senegal (1)	2
Q 3 1. (b)	Accept any one of the following: • It is near/nearer/close/closer to Ile de France. • It is a shorter route. • The voyage by ship is shorter/ the sailing ships took less time. • Fewer slaves would die on the way as the sea route/voyage by sea is less risky/dangerous.	1

Q 3 1. (c)	Correct tracing of sea route in the ocean from Country 2 , Senegal, to Ile de France	1
Q 3 2. (a)	Accept any one of the following: • Pondicherry • Bengal	1
Q 3 2. (b)	Accept any two of the following: • Carpenter; Mason; Trader; Shopkeeper; Blacksmith; Artisan/Craftsman Sailor; Docker/Dockworker; Shipbuilder 1 mark for each correct job Accept: build houses/roads/places of worship, Government House/ docks/ quays etc	2
Question 4 (12 marks)		
Q 4 1. (a) (i)	• Beau Plan	1
Q 4 1. (a) (ii)	• L'Aventure du Sucre tells the story of the sugar industry in Mauritius .	1
Q 4 1. (b)	Accept any two of the following: 1 mark for each correct object • Cartography / Old maps • Paintings • Sculpture • Stamps • Old documents Accept any other valid answers	2

Q 4 1. (c)	Accept any two of the following: • Tortoises • Giant fruit bats • Ploughshare tortoise	2
Q 4 2.(a) (i)	Award one mark for the correct answer • Sugar production has decreased.	1
Q 4 2.(a) (ii)	Accept any one of the following: • Reduction in sugar cane cultivation [1]– Some agricultural land previously used for sugar cane was converted to other uses. [1] • Land under sugar cane cultivation decreased over time [1] and therefore sugar production also decreased [1]. • Some sugar factories closed [1], so less sugar was produced. [1] • Planters shifted to other crops or economic activities. • Unfavourable weather conditions [1] decreased sugar cane production. [1] • The price of our raw sugar fell [1], so producers were discouraged from producing more. [1] • The price of raw sugar decreased [1], so less sugar was produced. [1]	2
Q 4 2.(b) (i)	Accept any one of the following: • Muscovado • Demerara • Golden Caster	1
Q 4 2.(b) (ii)	Accept any two of the following: 1 mark for each correct product • Rhum • Bioethanol • Molasses • Bagasse to produce electricity	2

Question 5 (8 marks)		
Q 5 (a) (i)	26.5° C	1
Q 5 (a) (ii)	22.0° C	1
Q 5 (b)	Accept any one of the following: - Because it is summer in January [1] and winter in July [1] - Because January is a summer month [1] and July a winter month [1] - Because it is hotter/warmer in January [1] and cooler in July [1]	2
Q 5 (c) (i)	Citronelle ☒	1
Q 5 (c) (ii)	Accept any one of the following: - Citronelle is cooler than Pointe Canon because it is at a higher altitude [1] compared to Pointe Canon. [1] - Citronelle is cooler than Pointe Canon because it is found on the Central Ridge [1], while Pointe Canon is in the lowland. [1] - Citronelle is 275m high [1] whereas Pointe Canon is 58m high. [1] - Citronelle is on high lands [1] whereas Pointe Canon is on lower lands. [1] Give one mark to: - Because of height/altitude - Because of different height or altitude	2
Q 5 (d)	A contour line	1

Question 6 (6 marks)		
Q 6 (a)	1 Leeward side 2 Windward side	2
Q 6 (b)	Award one mark for each correct answer (i) The prevailing winds are forced to rise over the <u>high slopes</u>. (ii) The prevailing winds in Mauritius blow from the <u>south east</u>. (iii) The rising air cools down and water vapour <u>condenses</u> to form clouds and gives rain. (iv) This type of rainfall is known as <u>relief</u> rain.	4
Question 7 (6 marks)		
Q 7 (a)	Accept any one of the following: • Agricultural • Residential • Infrastructural. Accept: • Forest / forestry / natural forest / wasteland	1
Q 7 (b)	Give one mark each to any two of these relevant changes: • More houses were built / the village became bigger. • Bungalows were / have been built. • There was / is less sugar cane. • More vegetable growing / more market gardening. • More roads have been built. • A supermarket has been built. • Trees / forests have been removed. • Wasteland has been used for building bungalows. • Filao trees / coconut trees were / have been planted near the hotel . (Accept any other valid changes for a good comparison)	2

Q 7 (c)	Give one mark for any two of the following relevant explanations: • Hotels provide comfortable accommodation for tourists. • Hotels offer facilities and services such as food/ swimming pools/ room service/ restaurant. • Tourists can relax without cooking or cleaning. • Hotels offer sea sport facilities such as skiing/ leisure crafts/boat cruises. • Hotels offer leisure activities. • Hotels organise visits and tours to places of interest/ entertainment such as musical shows. • Hotels provide security for tourists. Accept any other valid facilities	2
Q 7 (d)	Give one mark for any one of the following: • Grand Baie / Flic en Flac / Belle Mare / Riviere Noire / Bel Ombre / Le Morne/ Trou aux Biches. Accept any other relevant coastal area in Mauritius.	1
Question 8 (12 marks)		
Q 8 (a) (i)	• 1835	1
Q 8 (a) (ii)	Give one mark to any one of the following: • Suburbs of Port Louis/ Port Louis • On the coast • In forests • Along main roads • In villages	1

Q 8 (a) (iii)	Give one mark each for any two of the following occupations: • Mason, carpenter, artisan, trader/tradesman, coachman, driver, gardener, docker, fisherman, hunter, shoemaker, etc. Accept any other valid occupation that is appropriate to the place identified in part (a)(ii).	2
Q 8 (a) (iv)	Give one mark each for any two of the following reasons: • They wanted to enjoy their freedom after the abolition of slavery. • They did not want to work under the same masters again. • The work on the sugar estates was very hard and wages were low. • They wanted to live independently and make their own choices. • Some preferred to grow their own food or do other jobs (such as traders and artisans). • They wanted to move away from the sugar estates where they had suffered. • They wanted to move away from the sugar estates where they were been badly treated/severely punished. • They did not want to bear the hardships on sugar estates (living and working conditions e.g. long hours of work). • They had better job/work opportunities in Port Louis/ on the coast / in villages. Accept any other relevant answers.	2

Q 8 (b) (i)	Give one mark for each of the following: • Port X : Calcutta /Kolkata [1] • Port Y: Bombay/ Mumbai [1] • Port Z: Madras/ Chennai [1]	3																		
Q 8 (b) (ii)	• Aapravasi Ghat / Immigration depot	1																		
Q 8 (b) (iii)	Accept any two of the following: • Rice • Dhol • Salted fish • Oil	2																		
Question 9 (8 marks)																				
Q 9 (a) (i)	Give one mark to each of the three correct matching <table> <thead> <tr> <th>Column A</th><th></th><th>Column B</th></tr> </thead> <tbody> <tr> <td>Red</td><td>•</td><td>• The golden sunshine</td></tr> <tr> <td>Blue</td><td>•</td><td>• The abundant vegetation</td></tr> <tr> <td>Yellow</td><td>•</td><td>• The struggle for freedom and independence</td></tr> <tr> <td>Green</td><td>•</td><td>• The island's tourism</td></tr> <tr> <td></td><td></td><td>• The Indian Ocean surrounding the island</td></tr> </tbody> </table>	Column A		Column B	Red	•	• The golden sunshine	Blue	•	• The abundant vegetation	Yellow	•	• The struggle for freedom and independence	Green	•	• The island's tourism			• The Indian Ocean surrounding the island	3
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Q 9 (a) (ii)	• Jean Georges Prosper	1																		
Q 9 (b) (i)	• Dodo	1																		
Q 9 (b) (ii)	• The star [1] and key [1] of the Indian Ocean	2																		

Q 9 (b) (iii)	Give one mark for any one of the following: • Because sugar cane is important for the island's economy. • Because sugar cane is a major crop grown on the island. • Because sugar cane is/ has played an important role in the country's history. • Because sugar cane was the first crop introduced in Mauritius. • It reminds us of the Dutch (settlement). • Sugarcane is the main crop / cash crop of Mauritius.	1
Question 10 (11 marks)		
Q 10 1 (a)	Give one mark to any one of these conditions: • Sea temperature is high. • Hot seas / oceans. • Warm sea surface. • Temperature of sea / ocean above 26.5°C / 27°C	1
Q 10 1 (b)	• 60°E	1
Q 10 1 (c) (i)	• Rodrigues	1
Q 10 1 (c) (ii)	Give one mark to any one of the following reasons: • Cyclone Bansi passed very close to Rodrigues. • Because Rodrigues was close to the cyclone's track.	1
Q 10 1 (d)	Give one mark each to any two of the following reasons: • It can cause harm/damage to the people. • It can cause harm/damage to the environment. • It can cause damage to the buildings / infrastructure. • It can cause loss of lives (people get killed/hurt). <u>No mark to:</u> • Because a cyclone occurs naturally. • It is not man-made.	2

Q 10 1 (e)	Give one mark each to any two of the following precautions: • Ensure that your house is in good condition/can withstand cyclone gusts. • Trim tree branches that could damage your house/ telephone or electricity lines. • Clear your property of loose material that could fly. • Prepare an emergency kit with essentials (radio, water, food, medicines, etc.). Accept any other precautions mentioned on page 80 of Grade 6 Teacher's Book.	2
Q 10 2 (a)	• Karthala	1
Q 10 2 (b)	Give one mark each to any two of the following advantages: • Fertile land • Tourist attraction	2